



opportunity to be part of it," Mamdani said.

U.S. President Donald Trump has also joined the conversation, saying: "I would certainly like to be there, but I wouldn't pay it either, to be honest with you."

For FIFA president Gianni Infantino, however, the prices reflect demand. Defending the cost of tickets, he pointed to "unprecedented" interest and said: "Our entry price, which is USD60, is the lowest entry price of any of the American sports and the playoff phases. Our average price, which is below USD500, is again the lowest of the American sports on average."

The ticket itself is only part of the expense. Transport has emerged as

another flashpoint. Fans travelling from New York to MetLife Stadium faced a special round-trip fare that initially sparked outrage online. Defending the charge, New Jersey Transit said the fare structure was designed to support the additional services required for the World Cup and later noted that a revised USD 98 round-trip ticket was made possible through additional advertising revenue rather than taxpayer subsidies.

The debate is not confined to the United States. Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum said she missed her country's opening match because "Tickets are very expensive."

Last month, New Jersey Attorney General Jennifer Davenport and New

Differing view: Despite the growing chorus of criticism, FIFA president Gianni Infantino remains unmoved, insisting the prices simply reflect demand. AP

York Attorney General Letitia James launched an investigation into FIFA's ticketing practices, including its use of variable pricing.

As football's biggest event grows richer, the people who give it meaning are finding themselves priced out.

For now, they continue to search ticket websites, compare train fares and make compromises. The dream of attending a World Cup remains alive. Whether it remains affordable is another matter.